



Emerging sports

Market and business model assessment

March 2026



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Dear Sir / Madam,

Project Bounce – Emerging sports market review

We report on Project Bounce in accordance with our agreement dated 31st October 2025. This report has been prepared for the purpose of providing an independent assessment an independent review of new and emerging sports properties and the business models that drive and sustain them.

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Yours faithfully

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Key findings



Tie Break Tens is well positioned to enhance the existing tennis eco-system and further solidify its positioning

Tie Break Tens overview

Executive Summary

Market trends across key sports stakeholder groups are **supporting the growth of short-form competitions**:

- **Fans:** Younger audiences (fans of the future) show different consumption behaviours and preferences to older fans. This cohort of fans is increasingly selective in **how, when and where it consumes sport**, often prioritising **personality-led, short-form and community-driven** content. In this context, long-form viewing is no longer the default premium experience – it is one option amongst many
- **Rightsholders:** Are experiencing **challenges to core revenue streams** (media rights and sponsorship) and facing **greater competition for audience attention**. Tennis is now not only competing against other sports, but also with a wide range of cultural and entertainment experiences. **Innovation for rightsholders must therefore go beyond format or rule changes** to ensure cut through in this new context
- **Investors:** Are increasingly **prioritising investments into emerging and short-form sports formats**, given (i) greater ability to participate (at manageable investment quantum) vs legacy properties, (ii) **high ability to scale** from servicing new audiences and (iii) greater control over IP and innovation

Tie Break Tens, the ITF's official short-format tennis partner, is well-suited to capitalise on the market opportunity for a complementary, fit-for-purpose Tennis product, as:

- Existing properties are **not optimally positioned** to take advantage of consumption trends given existing formats and embedded traditions
- Short-format tennis properties are **additive to the existing ecosystem**, expanding entry points and extending relevance rather than replacing long-form competitions
- New formats provide **gateways into the sport**, strengthening the overall tennis ecosystem rather than further fragmenting it
- There is a **gap for a mass participation offering**, which is currently underserved across the racquet sport ecosystem; this can support **earlier, more positive engagement** with tennis and more **proactively develop fandom**

"Tie Break Tens is such a fun format to play, it's fast, intense and brings out the best parts of tennis in a really concentrated way. Literally every point matters. It's great to see the format growing, because it shows how tennis can keep evolving while staying true to what makes it great"

- Taylor Fritz, ATP Tour Professional & Tie Break Tens Champion

Trends across fans, rightsholders and partners are driving growth in short-form and entertainment-led sports formats

Summary of key trends

Key trends across primary sports stakeholders

 Fans	- Today's sporting products largely cater for the preferences of older generations; however, the core audiences of tomorrow are the younger generations of today - Younger sports fans have a greater preference for new sporting concepts with innovative formats; they prefer personality-led, short-form and community-driven content and consume this via multiple digital channels	Participants - Participants (athletes, creators etc.) are a key enabler of the emerging sports ecosystem <i>Considered in detail in Comparator Benchmarking section</i>
 Rightsholders	Rightsholders are experiencing challenges to their core revenue streams (media rights, sponsorship), prompting recognition that innovation – whether within existing formats or through new products – is necessary to appeal to and monetise new and younger audiences	
 Investors	Investors appear to be prioritising emerging formats for investment, given (i) lower initial capital outlay required vs. established sports properties, (ii) high ability to scale, (iii) upside from servicing new audiences, and (iv) greater control over IP and innovation	

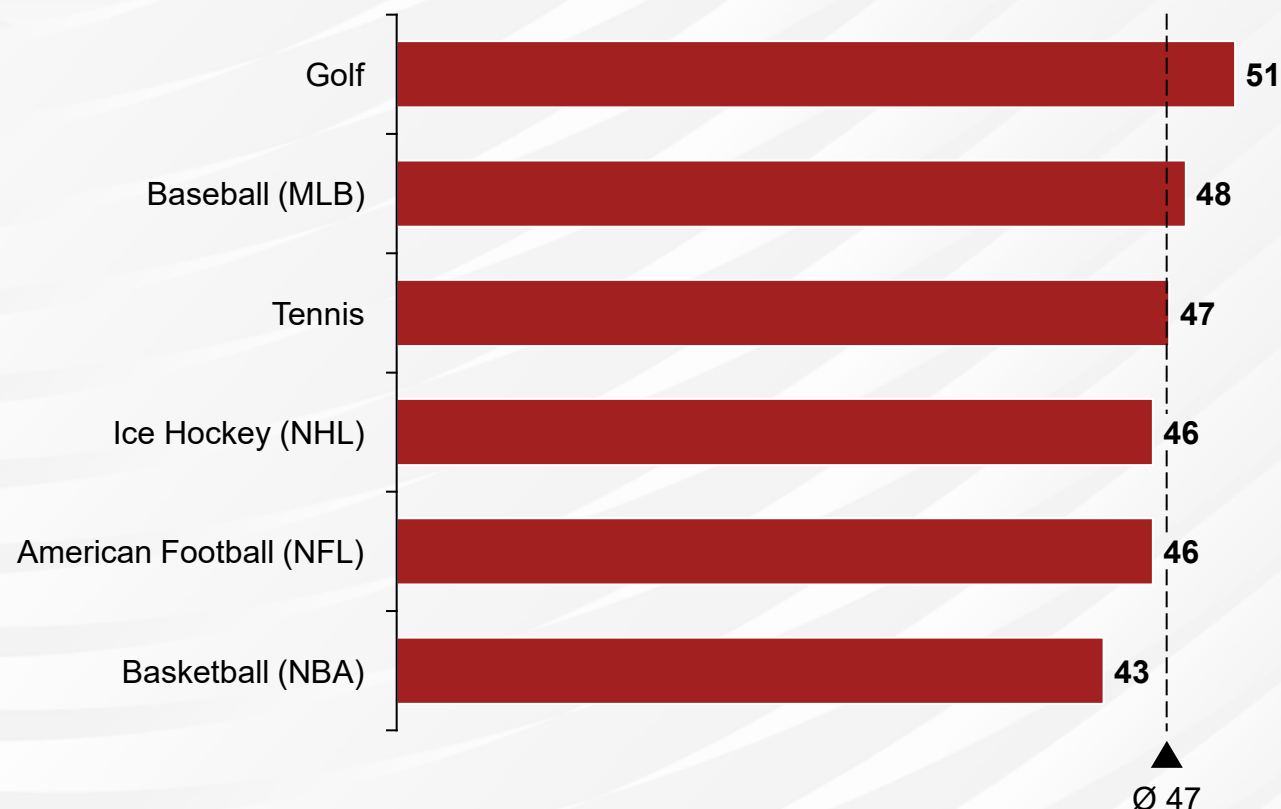
*Macro-economic tailwinds, specifically **growing populations**, **rising disposable income levels** and **expanding connectivity** are supportive of new sports formats*

The average age of major sport fans is c.50, meaning today's sports properties are largely centred around the preferences of older generations

Age of major sport fans

Median age of fans of sport¹, USA

Age, n = 7,064, 2024



*“Traditional networks like Sky and TNT **still** program for television-first audiences...but **linear TV is ageing out**. Traditional broadcasters **risk losing entire generations** if they don't evolve”*

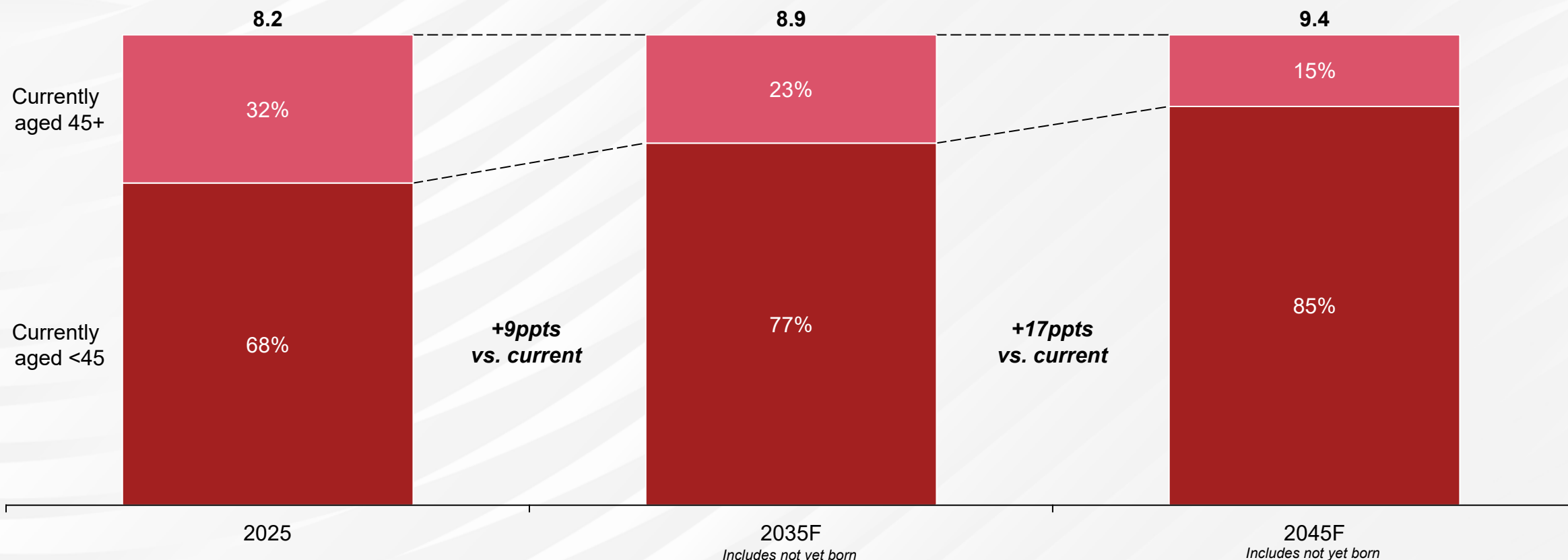
- Director, Two Circles

However, the preferences of younger generations are key to future success; current under-45s (including those not yet born) will make up c.85% of people by 2045

Global generational shift

Global population breakdown, by age group

bn, %, 2025 vs. 2035 vs. 2045

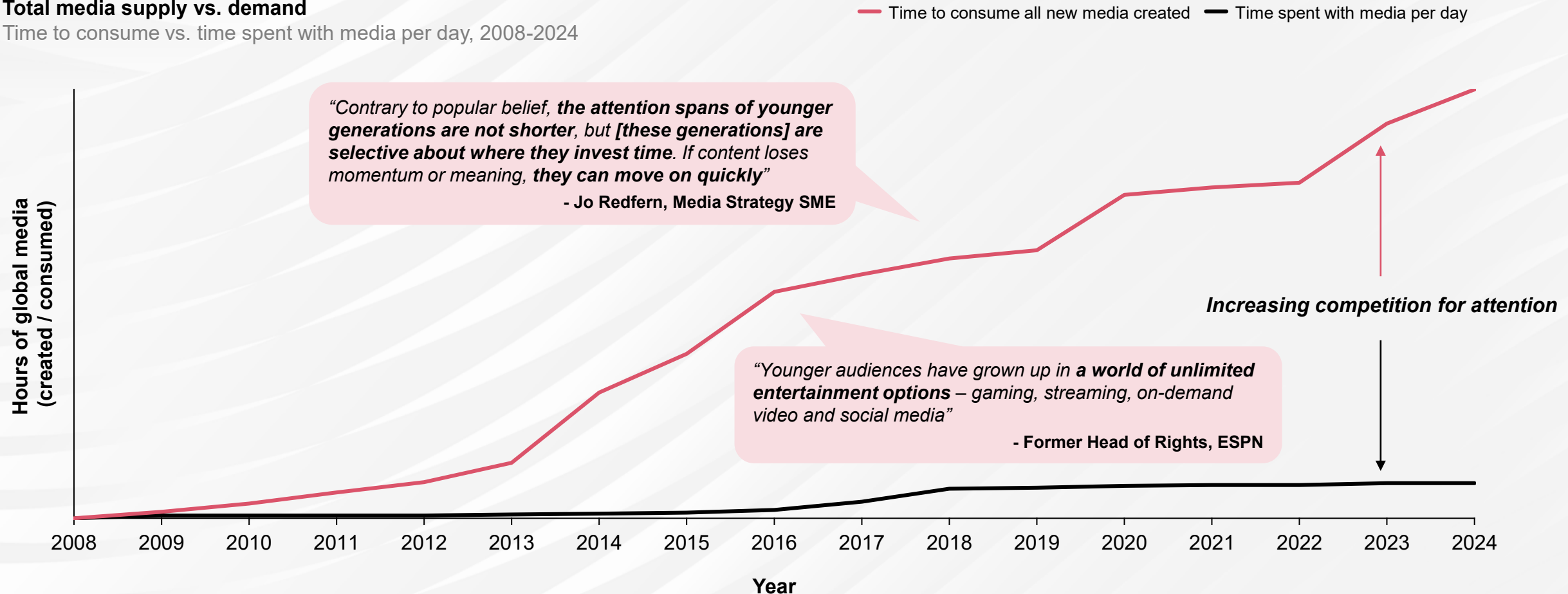


Competition for consumer attention is increasing as content supply grows; younger fans are being more selective over which content they consume

Competition for consumer attention

Total media supply vs. demand

Time to consume vs. time spent with media per day, 2008-2024



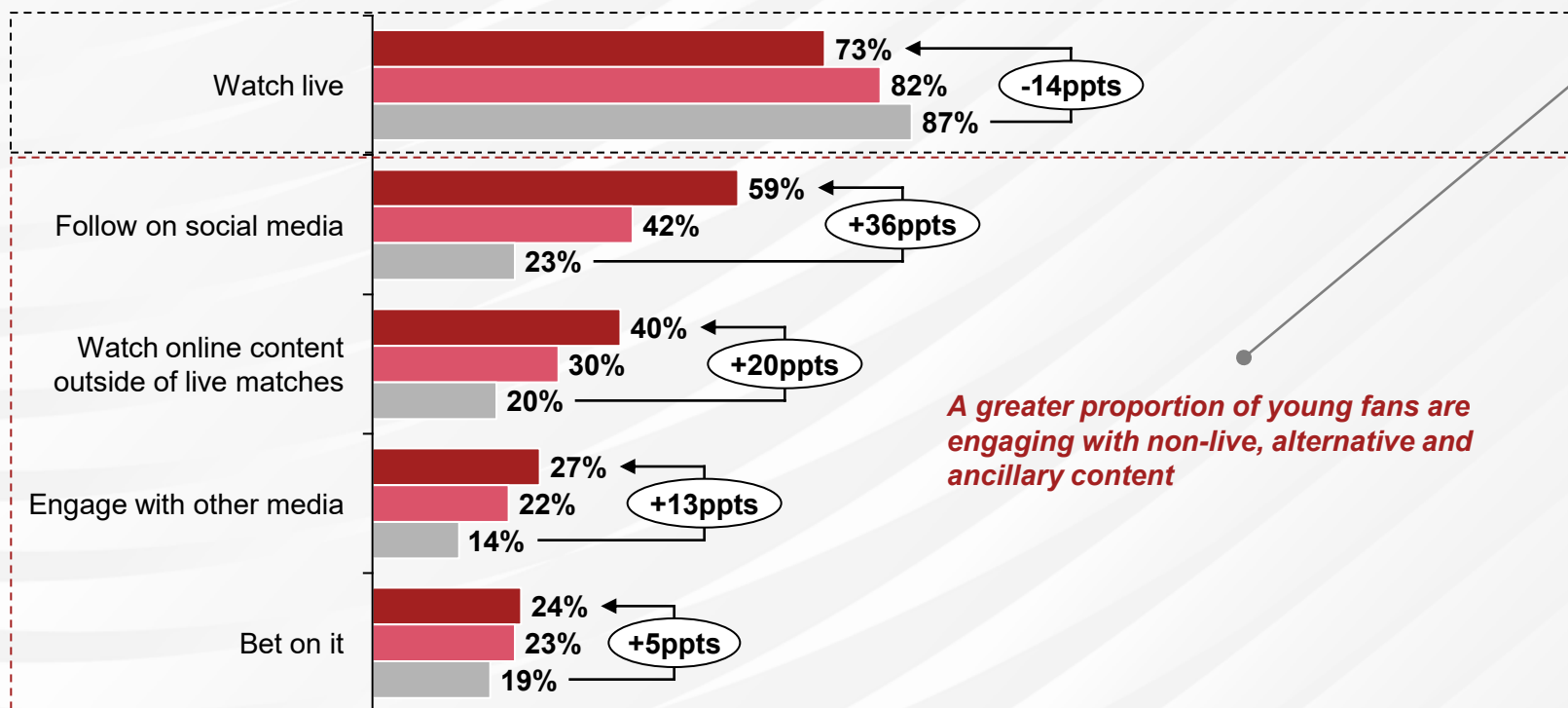
Younger audiences are increasingly prioritising non-live content (e.g., highlights, ancillary, gaming) compared to middle-aged and older generations...

Consumption preferences

“How best to describe how you engage with sport?” – by age bracket

n = 1,552, % of respondents, UK, 2025

■ Aged 18-34 ■ Aged 35-54 ■ Aged 55-64



Note: Younger audiences are not disengaging with sport; they are curating their sports consumption more intentionally

*“Audiences under 24 have **never known life without smartphones or constant connectivity**”*

- Media Strategy SME

*“Modern audiences are **spread across ecosystems**. A broadcaster must demonstrate that it can reach fans wherever they are – through **live coverage, highlights, behind the scenes storytelling, and alternate formats**.”*

- Former Head of Rights, ESPN

A greater proportion of young fans are engaging with non-live, alternative and ancillary content

...and consume sports content via different channels; short-form and community-driven content is winning their attention

Format preferences

Most young sports fans view their content in short-form via social media

Large proportions of younger sports fans also prefer athlete- or creator-led content, which is often more participatory in nature, or via interactive and gaming experiences

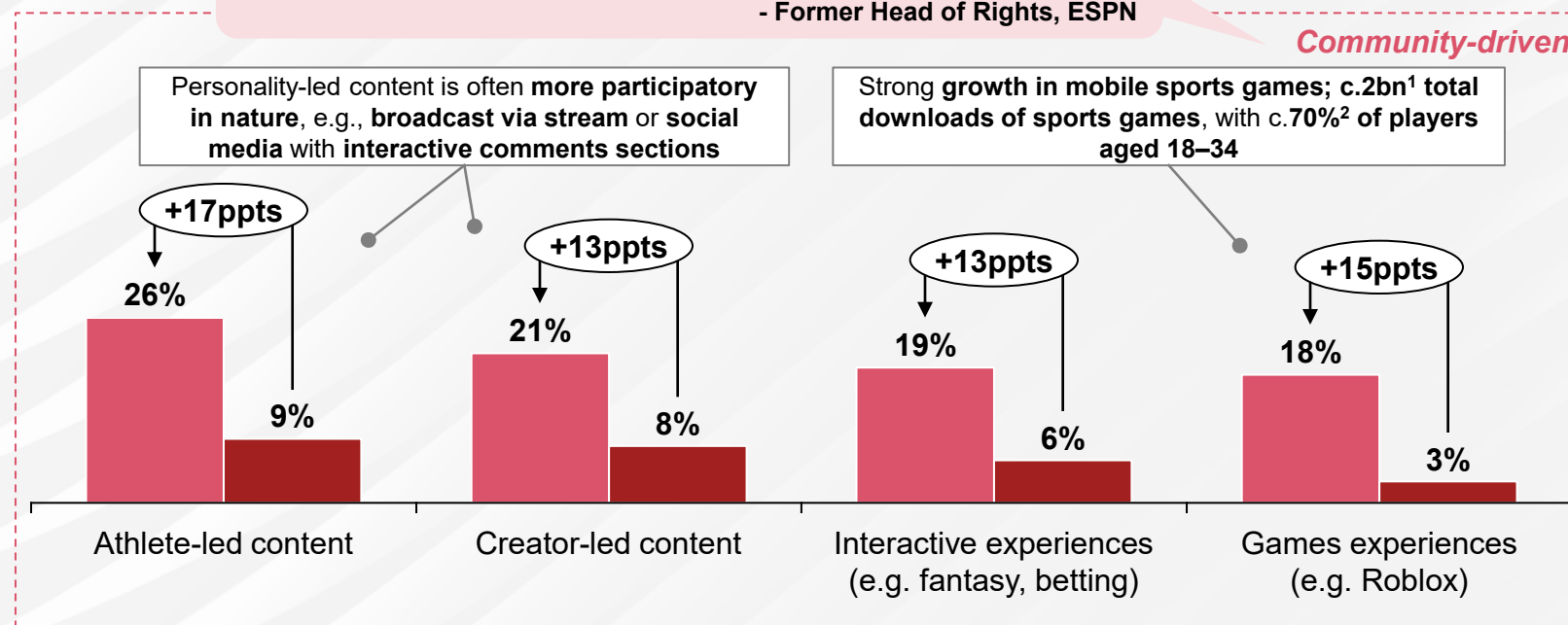
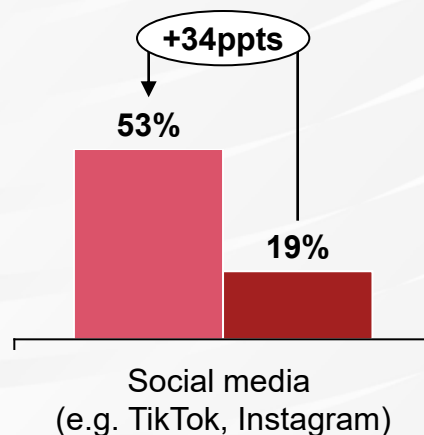
“How do you typically consume your favourite sports media?”
n = 7,250, % of mentions by respondents, 2025

“Younger fans expect content to be *interactive, bite-sized and personalised.*”

18-34 55+

- Former Head of Rights, ESPN

Short-form



Increased multi-channel consumption

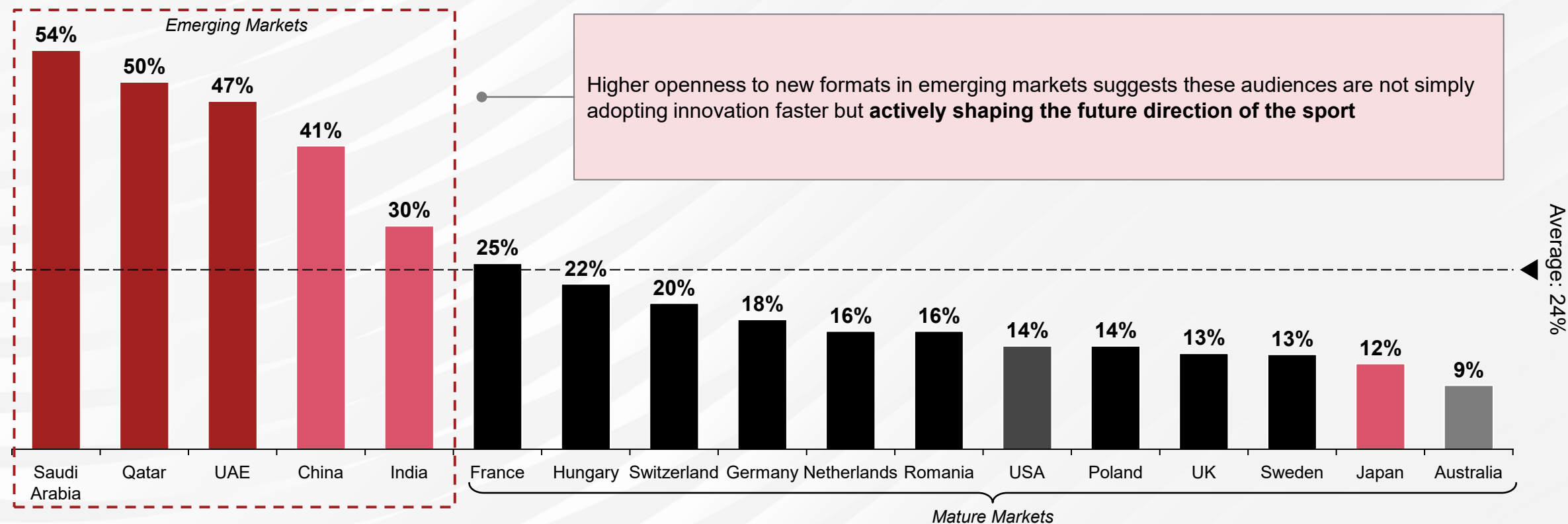
Fans in emerging markets, including the Middle East, China and India, show a greater openness to new concepts vs. those in mature markets

Market assessment

Preference for new sporting leagues / concepts¹

% of respondents indicating preference for new sporting leagues / concepts, N = 7,250 sports fans

■ Middle East ■ Asia ■ Europe ■ N. America ■ Oceania



Challenges with core revenue streams are prompting rightsholders to innovate to appeal to and monetise new and younger audiences

Rightsholder innovation

Traditional properties are making adjustments to cater to younger consumption habits

Property			
Rule changes	Added pitch clock, limits on pitcher disengagements; bigger bases	Implemented stricter pace-of-play and time limit rules (e.g., 40 seconds to play a stroke)	Added 60-second stop-clock between overs, with penalties for repeated breaches
Outcome	• Biggest one-year increase in attendance in 30 years (+9%) • Game time reduction by 24 min • Stolen base attempts up by c.30%	• Median round time decreased by 5 minutes per round • Less 'downtime' for spectators	• Game time reduction by c.20 minutes (ODI) • Material reduction in 'dead time' • Permanently implemented in ODI & T20, and later extended to test cricket

...while others have endorsed entirely new short-form formats

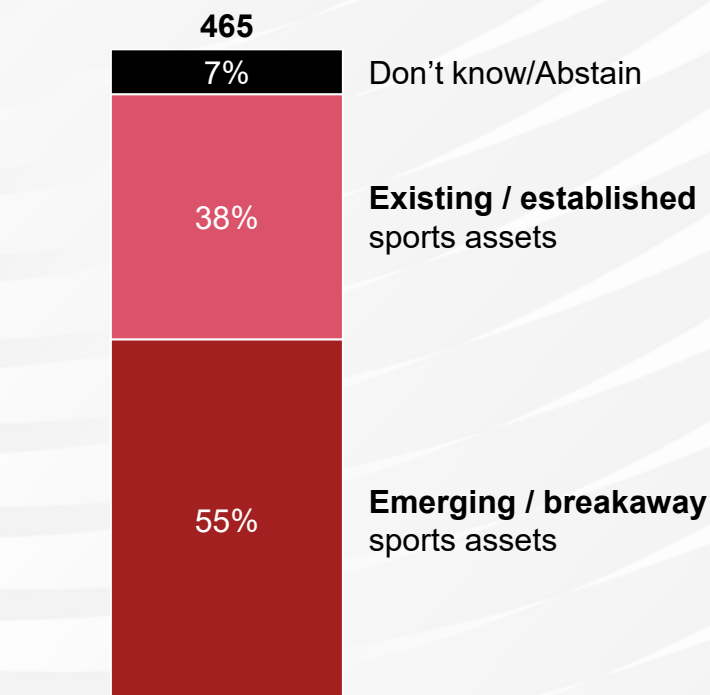
Property				
Innovation	Launched FIBA 3x3 World Tour in 2012; included in Olympics from 2020	Launched the Hundred inaugural season in 2021	Integrated TB10 format into ITF's Joint Tennis Initiative in 2025	Established in 2023 as US-based Women's 3x3 basketball league
Ambition	Establish an urban, accessible format	Attract new audiences and drive high-quality entertainment	Build new tennis fandom & grow participation globally	World-class women's competition in a digestible, fan-first format

Investors appear to be prioritising emerging formats, which offer greater control and better growth opportunities, while requiring lower up-front capital outlay

Investor appeal

Will investors continue to prioritise investment into existing / established sports assets, or prioritise investment into emerging / breakaway assets?

%, single choice, N = 465 sports executives



Investor preference

Factors driving attractiveness of emerging sports assets to investors

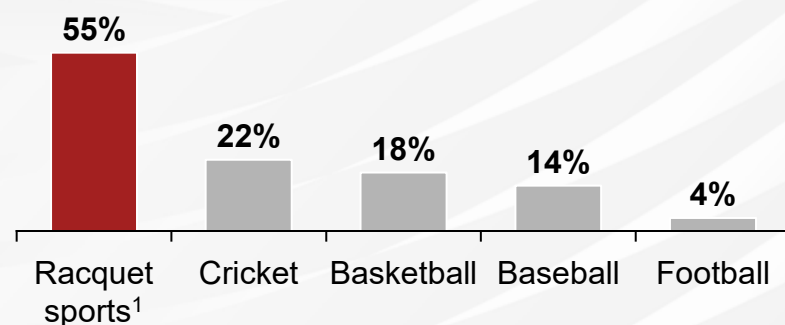
Factor	Overview
 Lower up-front capital outlay	Emerging formats are more accessible to investors, as lower up-front capital is required vs. established sports properties
 High scalability potential	Digital-first approach of many emerging formats enables fast fanbase growth and greater opportunity to scale
 More upside from new audiences	Emerging formats target newer, younger audiences that are currently underserved by traditional rightsholders – unlocking potential upside
 Greater innovation control	Emerging formats have greater control over innovation (incl. league format, branding, location etc.) vs. established properties that are restricted by governing bodies, traditions and embedded cultures

Racquet sports have experienced strong growth in interest and viewership over recent years, supported by several tailwinds

Racquet sports growth

Total participant growth (top 5 participated sports)

Global # of participants, 2020-2025

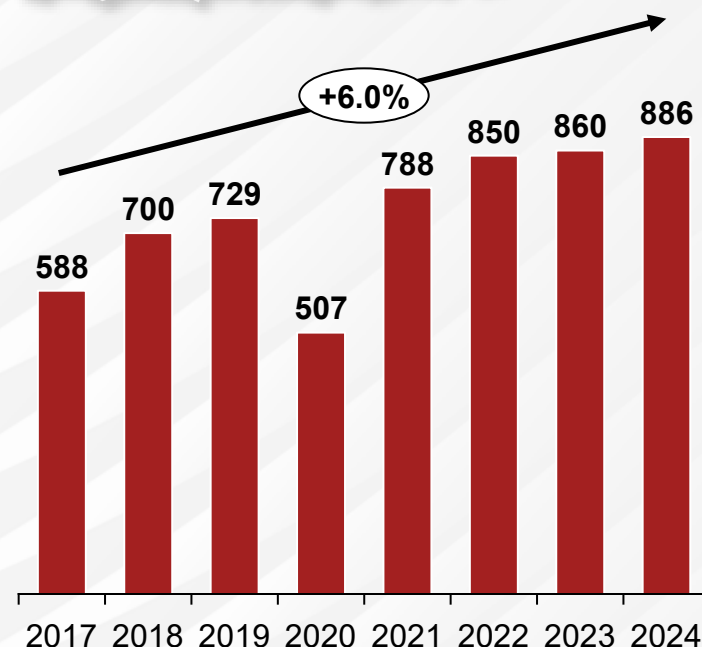


Annual media rights value of tennis properties

\$m, 2015-2025

Insider Sport | March 2025

WTA Surpasses 1.1bn viewers to achieve biggest season yet

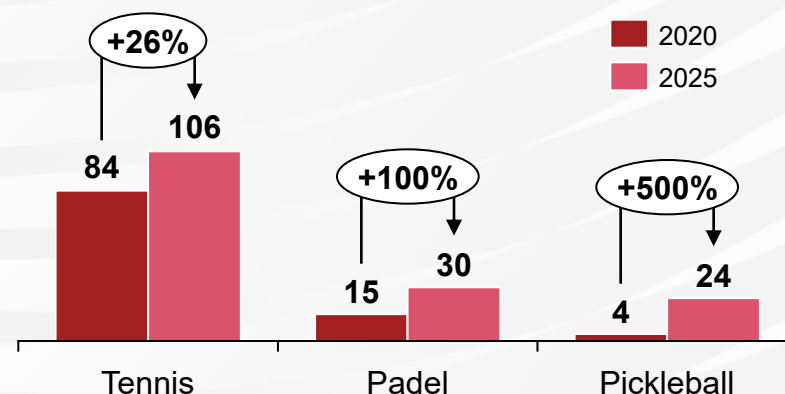


Drivers of racquet sports growth

- **New generation of stars:** new star talent, (e.g., Carlos Alcaraz, Jannik Sinner) have replaced the 'Big Three' as viewership draws
- **Increased coverage:** media coverage of major events has expanded significantly; streaming platforms and social media have made live and on-demand coverage more accessible to fans
- **Greater accessibility:** public courts and community programs are making it easier to participate, while new formats such as pickleball require minimal equipment and space
- **Expanding health trends:** racquet sports have benefited from wider active lifestyle campaigns, and from being safe sports that can be played across ages and fitness levels
- **Proliferating new formats:** accessible new formats are growing rapidly; pickleball is the fastest growing sport in the US, while padel has achieved strong growth in Europe

Total racquet sports players growth

Global # of participants, 2020-2025



There is an evident opportunity within the racquet sports ecosystem for a new, fit-for-purpose property to complement existing formats, namely within tennis

Opportunity for short-form racquet sport

Overview of existing major racquet sports properties

Racquet Sport Tournaments		Founded	Avg. Match Length	Proposition	Commercial Maturity	Mass participation offering?
Tennis	Grand Slams	1877-1905	3-5hrs	Four cornerstone events held annually, featuring best players, long match formats and distinct global host settings	H	X
	ATP / WTA Tours	1972-1973	1.5-2hrs	Year-round global circuits featuring elite players, rankings, and prestigious tournaments across diverse locations	H	X
	Ultimate Tennis Showdown	2020	45 mins	Challenger short-form format targeting younger audiences with fast-paced gameplay and innovative rule set	L	X
Padel	Premier Padel	2022	1.5hrs	International tour featuring top-ranked players, standardized events and growing global footprint across emerging markets	M	X
	Pro Padel League	2023	1.5hrs	North American league with franchise teams, season-based competition and focus on local market development	L	X
Pickleball	Major League Pickleball	2021	1-1.5hrs	U.S.-based pickleball league featuring team-based competition, draft system and fast-paced format	M	X
	Professional Pickleball Association	2019	1hr	U.S. tour featuring ranking-based tournaments, structured calendar, with amateur brackets alongside each tournament	L	✓

Summary of opportunity

- ✓ Leading tennis properties are **not optimally positioned** to take advantage of key trends given **existing formats** and **embedded traditions**
- ✓ Short-format properties can be **additive to the existing ecosystem**, **expanding entry points** and **extending relevance**
- ✓ New formats provide **gateways into the sport**, **strengthening the overall tennis ecosystem** rather than further fragmenting it
- ✓ There is a **gap for a mass participation** offering; this can support **earlier and more positive engagement with tennis**

***Tie Break Tens** is well-positioned to **capitalise on the market opportunity** by bridging **elite competition** and **mass participation**, while delivering a distinctive fan proposition: a short-form, two-hour tournament featuring 8-16 pre-identified players, enabling fans to easily follow and support their favourite athletes*



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Reinvent tomorrow.

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